

Tree house

Look closely at a mature European oak tree and you will find an amazing array of animals making their homes there. For some, food is also provided in the form of acorns.



Bed and breakfast

An oak tree produces 90,000 acorns a year. They are eaten by forest animals, but wood pigeons are the greediest: they can stuff 70 acorns into their throat.

Tree house facts

The oak tree holds the European record for the most number of animals living in a tree. It is home to

- 30 species of birds
- 200 species of moths
- thousands of insects



Nursery food

A female acorn weevil uses her long snout to drill into an acorn before laying her eggs inside. When they hatch, the babies, or larvae, feed on the acorn.



Going batty

Bats' favourite roosts are in dark, hidden places where they can shelter during the daytime. Hollows inside tree trunks and rotten boughs are ideal. In some countries, bats prefer to live in trees.

Rabbit run

Down among the roots of the oak, there is a network of underground tunnels, which form a rabbit warren. The soil here is easy to dig.

